



Introduction to Entrepreneurship Syllabus

Fall Semester 2018

BUS 410: Introduction to Entrepreneurship
Pandora, P514

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

Instructor: Kate Luczko, <https://www.linkedin.com/in/kateluczko/>

Instructor Contact Information: kateluczko@gmail.com, cell (603) 661-7822 (if you text me, please identify yourself); Available to meet before/after class or by appointment. I do not have an office on campus. Please send me an email to arrange a meeting. Please don't hesitate to contact me at any point. Early and open communication is key in preventing future struggles.

Class Meeting Time: Fridays 1:00p-4:00p

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course explores the structure and framework of entrepreneurial endeavors. Topics to be addressed include: The fundamentals of entrepreneurship, including start-ups, franchises, family-owned business, purchasing existing businesses; Marketing and Sales, including market research and positioning, pricing, promotion; Financing and Financial Statements; Legal issues and Risk; Operations; and Leadership, including hiring and organizational structure, ethics, and social responsibility.

COURSE APPROACH

Each week we will have a lecture and/or class discussion, frequently in addition to group exercises, video cases, or guest speakers, where practical entrepreneurial business issues can be seen in action and explored with more depth. The intent is for you to explore ways in which to think through and apply the concepts and frameworks we are studying. After breaking down all of the pieces, this course culminates with the creation of a full business plan.

Students are expected to come to class having read all the assigned reading carefully, and fully prepared to participate in class discussions and other activities.

Most in-person class sessions will also include the visits by local New Hampshire-based Guest Speakers with functional expertise and extensive real-world working experience in the topical areas being covered. Learning from these business leaders, in a face-to-face setting, is a critical component of this course. Networking is an important element/skill of the business world and this is an opportunity for you to get to know these business leaders and perhaps begin forming relationships with them.

All of the class events, activities, and course readings are detailed on the attached Semester Schedule.

CLASS EXPECTATIONS

1. Attendance counts. You must be present – physically and mentally – and ready to go.
2. Please be on time. This is a business class; treat it as you would a job.
3. Be prepared for class. Be engaged. Participate. Ask questions.
4. Engage in a professional manner. We all have differing opinions and we must be respectful of the positions of others.
5. Attention to detail and well-written (and spoken) assignments matter. Strive for quality, clarity, and depth in your work.
6. Prepare and submit your work on time. Do not wait until the last minute; build in time to accommodate the unexpected. Assignments are due at the beginning of the scheduled class on the syllabus in hard-copy (printed) format and uploaded to the corresponding assignment in Canvas. Late work will **not** be accepted.
7. Cell phone use is not appropriate in the classroom. Please don't make this an issue. Please turn your ringers off. No texting. If you have a family/work emergency, please take your phone out into the hallway.
8. The use of laptops or tablets will not be permitted in this class, unless it is a component of our session.

REQUIRED MATERIALS

1. "Entrepreneurship & Small Business Management" by Steve Mariotti & Caroline Glackin, (2nd edition), ISBN: 978-0133767186. Available at the UNHM bookstore and online.
2. Canvas is the University-wide information system. Canvas is an integral and required component of this course. Assignments, documents, and announcements will be posted regularly on the Canvas site. You will be required to submit your assignments via Canvas and participate in online discussions. Thus, your regular use of Canvas is required.
3. A pen/pencil, a notebook, and a binder that you will use specifically for this class. Remember, there will be no laptops allowed in the classroom.

GRADING POLICY & EVALUATION

Grading will be distributed as follows:

Homework

- Please note that any homework is considered professional writing practice so that: grammar, punctuation, organization, and spelling absolutely count.
- All homework combined is worth **45%** of your course grade.

Thought Papers

- Reflection is a vital component to learning and development, which you will practice through your writing in this class. The 5 Thought Papers will contribute a significant component of your individual development this term. These are not a “trip report” of your daily work or a play-by-play of what we did in class. Each paper is graded up to 10 points towards your final grade. This counts as one of your “homework” assignments.

Each of the below will also count as a “homework” assignment.

- **Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)**
- **Marketing Assignment**
- **Honest Tea Case Study**
- **Values Assignment**
- **LinkedIn**
- **Ethics Assignment**

Informational Interview Assignment

- A great deal of learning occurs outside the classroom. Informational interviews offer the chance for you to learn about a person’s career path and their profession/business from an inside vantage point, providing information often unable to be obtained from other sources. It could also pave the way for a mentor relationship down the road, if done well. The Informational Interview is worth **15%** of your final grade.

Business Plan

- Each student will also be responsible (as part of a semester-long project) for building, writing, and presenting a comprehensive Business Plan for an organization of your choice, as approved in advance. Again, a separate handout will be provided with more specific guidelines. The Business Plan, worth **25%** of your final grade, is due in class.

Participation

- This class requires students to be engaged, to ask questions, and to participate in discussions (both in-person and online). Incomplete assignments will impact your ability to participate and ultimately, impact your participation grade. Given its importance, class participation will be included as a specific element of your semester grade for this course, worth **15%** of your final grade.

Attendance

- It is expected that students will attend and be on time for all class meetings. If you cannot attend a class or need to be late please email me *prior* to class. Students are responsible for material covered in any missed class. Every student is allowed one excused absence (with advance notification), but beyond that, absences and

tardiness will impact your grade. Missing 6 classes will result in a failing grade. Being late to 3 classes = 1 missed class.

Assignments are due at the beginning of the scheduled class on the syllabus in hard-copy (printed) format and **also** uploaded to the corresponding assignment in Canvas. **Late assignments will not be accepted.**

If you miss a class session it is **your** responsibility to obtain notes or information from classmates or ask the instructor if you have questions. Please take full advantage of these resources.

Extra Credit

- Given the importance of networking in the business and entrepreneurial world, I will give you extra credit for each of our guest speakers with whom you follow-up after class. You **must** cc or bcc me on your email to them, and it **must** be within 24 hours of their visit to our class. I will not provide you with their contact information, so I suggest you connect with them while they are in the classroom. Your thank you should reference something they said that struck you, or a lesson you learned from them, or something more qualitative than just "Thanks for coming to speak to my class." Make it genuine, thoughtful. While you will not get extra credit if your follow-up is sent beyond 24 hours, I would still strongly recommend you do so. Request to connect with them on LinkedIn too!

GRADING

Grading: Is based on 660 possible points below. Grades at .5 or above will be rounded up to next grade. e.g., a 79.5 average would be graded B-.

Homework, including: Thought Papers, LinkedIn, other assignments and online discussions	45%	110 points
Interview	15%	150 points
Business Plan	25%	250 points
Participation (attendance & value added)	15%	150 points
TOTAL	100%	660 points

Typically, grades are based on an absolute scale as follows:

A	95-100	A-	90-95		
B+	87-90	B	83-87	B-	80-83
C+	77-80	C	73-77	C-	70-73
D+	67-70	D	63-67	D-	60-63
F	<60				

SUPPORT

If you need help on class materials, homework, etc., please contact me as noted above to arrange a one-on-one discussion.

If further tutoring or academic support is needed, (i.e.: for mathematics/statistics, sciences, among other fields) please contact the Center for Academic Excellence:

<https://manchester.unh.edu/current-students/tutoring>

Accessibility Support:

In order for any faculty member to provide support (such as extra time for exams), the student must be certified through the Accessibility Services office within the Academic Advising department. Faculty do not need to know any specifics except what has been agreed to by the disability counselor, Jenessa Zurek at

<https://manchester.unh.edu/disability-services>.

Appointments can be arranged by calling Academic Advising at (603) 641-4170.

Mental Health Screening and Counseling, including Substance Abuse:

In partnership with The Mental Health Center of Greater Manchester (MHCGM), UNH Manchester offers consultation visits on a walk-in basis in the Academic Advising department (located in the Student Services suites, 4th floor). Services include:

- Free confidential screening & consultation with a licensed mental health therapist.
- Referrals to mental health or substance misuse treatment, and assistance in understanding how to afford additional treatment (with or without insurance!) or find free services.

Fall semester walk-in hours: Tuesdays from 8:30a – 5:00p and Thursday mornings from 9:00a-1:00p. You may call ahead to be placed on the schedule by calling Academic Advising at (603) 641-4170.

Availability of counselors:

Emily Yergeau	Tuesdays – 9/19 or 9/26	8:30a-1:00p
Sarah Mason	Tuesdays beginning 9/19	1:00p-5:00p
Glenn Quinney	Thursdays beginning 9/13	9:00a-1:00p

If you or someone you know is experiencing a mental health or substance misuse crisis, please contact the Mobile Crisis Response Team (MCRT) at (800) 688-3544.

OTHER CONTACT & COMMUNICATION

I have provided contact information (above) for you to reach me. I check email frequently throughout the day. Similarly, you should check your email at least once a day, as I (and other faculty members) tend to send many emails during the course of the semester. These emails contain important course information and announcements, which are considered a part of your “participation” in this class. Please understand that if you choose not to check your email regularly, beyond impacting your own learning process (and your course grade), you may be at a significant disadvantage compared to your fellow students. The

commitment in the Business Program at UNHM is to achieve a 24-hour response window for all communication.

In addition, please contact me if you have any concerns or can foresee a need for special consideration or unusual circumstances. Those with potential work-related conflicts or possible child-care challenges (e.g. due to snow-days, illness, etc.) should see me as early as possible, to talk through these issues.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

You are required to act ethically, referencing the UNH policy at:

<https://www.unh.edu/student-life/academic-honesty-policy>

Welcome to Introduction to Entrepreneurship!

I look forward to getting to know and work with you this semester.

SEMESTER SCHEDULE

(subject to change by instructor)

DATE	Week #	CLASS TOPICS	ASSIGNMENTS DUE
Aug 31	1	WELCOME – Syllabus review Student Information Sheet Go over Informational Interview Assignment, LinkedIn	
Sept 7	2	Chapters 2, 3 & 21: Franchising; Finding Opportunity in an Existing Business; Franchising, Licensing, and Harvesting: Cashing in Your Brand Guest Speaker: Suzanne Delaney , <i>Owner, LOFTechnology</i> Business Casual Attire	- Read, Speaker Questions - Bring textbooks to class - Bring name placard - Thought Paper #1 - Bring name of interviewee and back-up
Sept 14	3	Chapters 1, 4 & 5: Entrepreneurs Recognize Opportunities; The Business Plan: Road Map to Success; Creating Business from Opportunity Guest Speaker: Keri Laman , <i>President, Tidewater Catering Group</i>	- Read, Speaker Questions - Contact your interviewee and schedule time - Draft of informational interview questions
Sept 21	4	Class ONLINE	- Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) Assignment: Online Forum
Sept 28	5	Guest Speaker: Tim Near , <i>Founder and CEO, Cyborg Lab</i> Go over Business Plan Project	- Speaker Questions - Final interview questions
Oct 5	6	Chapters 6, 7, 9 & 10: Exploring Your Market; Developing the Right Marketing Mix and Plan; Integrated Marketing Communications; Marketing Globally Chapter 11: Smart Selling and Effective Customer Service Guest Speaker: Jason Alexander , <i>Managing Partner, BANKW Staffing</i>	- Read, Speaker Questions - Thought Paper #2

DATE	#	CLASS TOPICS	ASSIGNMENTS DUE
Oct 12	7	Chapter 16: Addressing Legal Issues and Managing Risk Guest Speaker: Katherine Morneau , Morneau Law	- Read, Speaker Questions - Marketing Assignment
Oct 19	8	Class ONLINE – Informational Interview	- Conduct Informational Interview
Oct 26	9	Debrief interview assignment Start-Up Resources Panel: Andrea O'Brien , <i>Director</i> , Business Sustainability Program & <i>Business Advisor</i> , Small Business Development Center Joshua Cyr , <i>Director of Education & Acceleration</i> , Alpha Loft Roman Geletkanycz , <i>Mentor</i> , SCORE and COMPASS	- Read, Speaker Questions - Informational Interview Assignment
Nov 2	10	Chapters 8, 12, 13, 14 & 15: Pricing and Credit Strategies; Understanding and Managing Start-Up, Fixed, and Variable Costs; Using Financial Statements to Guide a Business; Cash Flow and Taxes; Financing Strategy: Debt, Equity, or Both? Guest Speaker: Ryan Warren , <i>CPA, Manager</i> , BerryDunn	- Read, Speaker Questions - Thought Paper #3 - LinkedIn connection due
Nov 9	11	Class ONLINE	- Values Assignment: Online Forum
Nov 16	12	Field Trip – Next Step Bionics & Prosthetics, 155 Dow Street, Suite 200, Manchester, NH 03101 Matthew Albuquerque , <i>CPO, President</i>	- Research Host and Bring Prepared Questions - Thought Paper #4

DATE	#	CLASS TOPICS	ASSIGNMENTS DUE
Nov 23	13	Thanksgiving Break – No Class!	Happy Thanksgiving!
Nov 30	14	Chapter 19: Human Resources and Management Chapter 20: Leadership and Ethical Practices Guest Speaker: TBD	- Read, Speaker Questions - Honest Tea Case Study
Dec 7	15	Class ONLINE	- Final Thought Paper #5 - Ethics Assignment: Online Forum
Dec 14	16	Business Plan Presentations	- Business Plans Due